



Peacekeeping, Conflict, Government Repression, and Human Rights

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Paper & Citations



Overview

Peacekeepers are more likely to be deployed to more severe conflicts (Gilligan & Stedman, 2003; Fortna, 2008), creating endogeneity concerns in evaluating post-conflict outcomes. Prior research has used matching to account for bias where military interventions happen which discards already limited data (Beardsley, 2012; Hegre et al. 2019; Kim & Sandler, 2022) or two-step models that examine the impact of negotiations on settlement but do not account for selection bias of where peacekeepers are sent to a conflict (Greig & Diehl, 2005).

Hypotheses

- H1:** 3rd-party military interventions worsen state repression and human rights violations.
- H2:** Conflicts over government or territory lowers repression but worsens human rights outcomes.
- H3:** Conflict resolutions preserving both state and non-state actors increase repression and human rights violations.

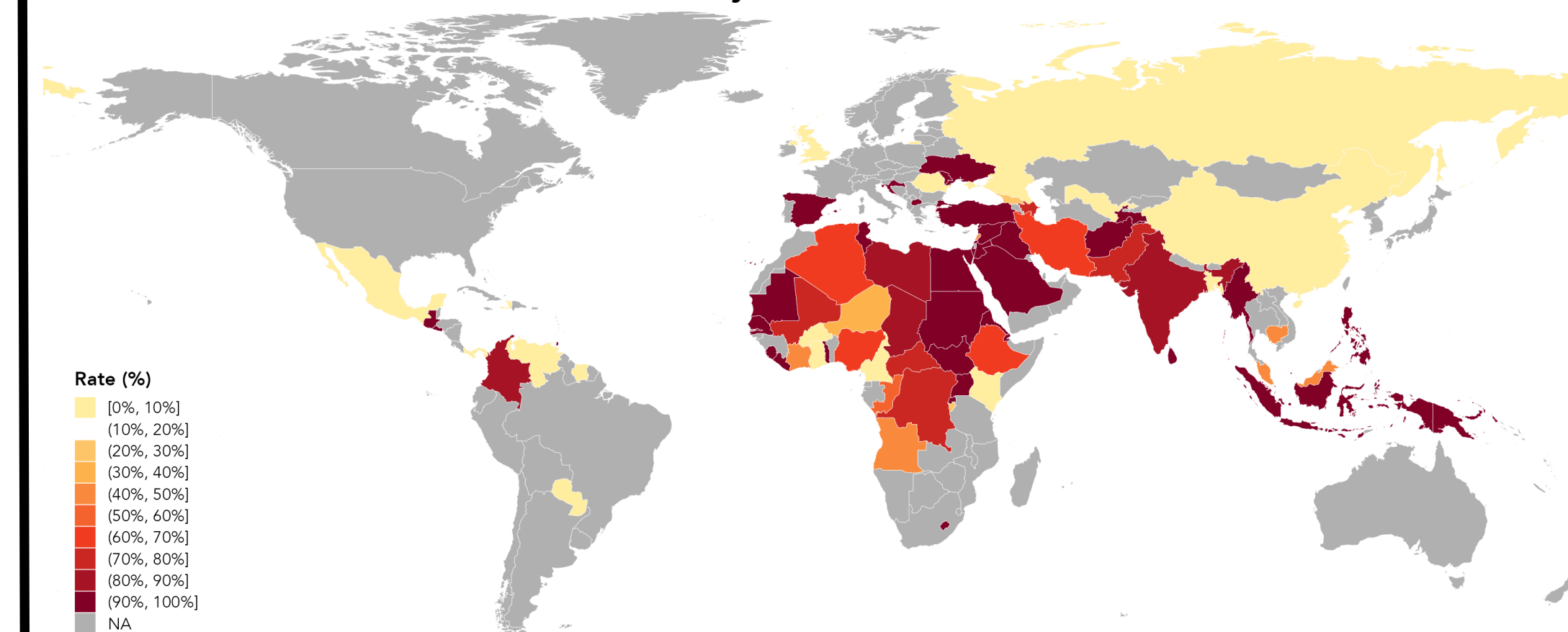
Methods

- Data from intrastate conflicts in 78 countries between 1975-2017
- Sources: UCDP/PRIO Armed Conflict Dataset, UCDP External Support Dataset, UNHCR Refugee counts, Correlates of War Direct Contiguity Dataset, V-Dem
- Bayesian endogenous treatment effects model handles endogeneity through joint estimation producing robust standard errors.

Data

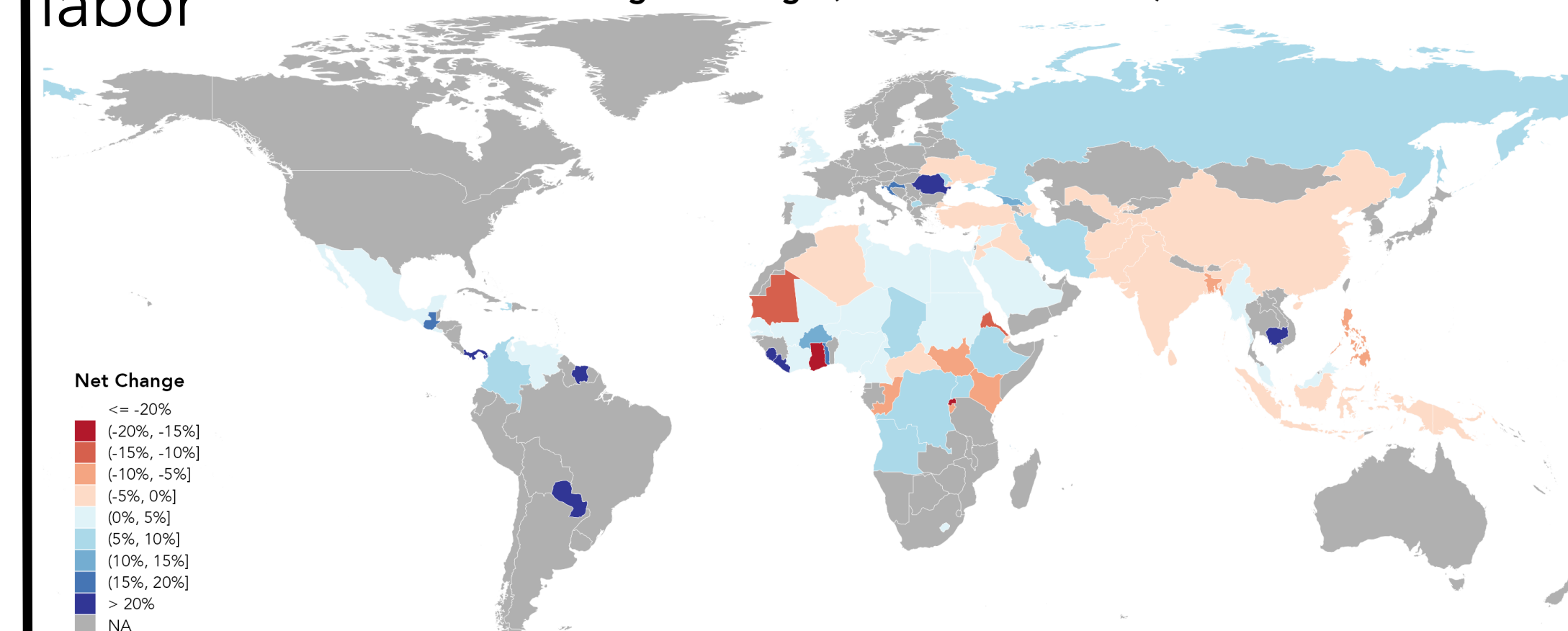
Military Intervention: external support in the form of troops, weapons, logistics, training, intelligence, territory actions, or infrastructure

Rate of Military Intervention Per Conflict



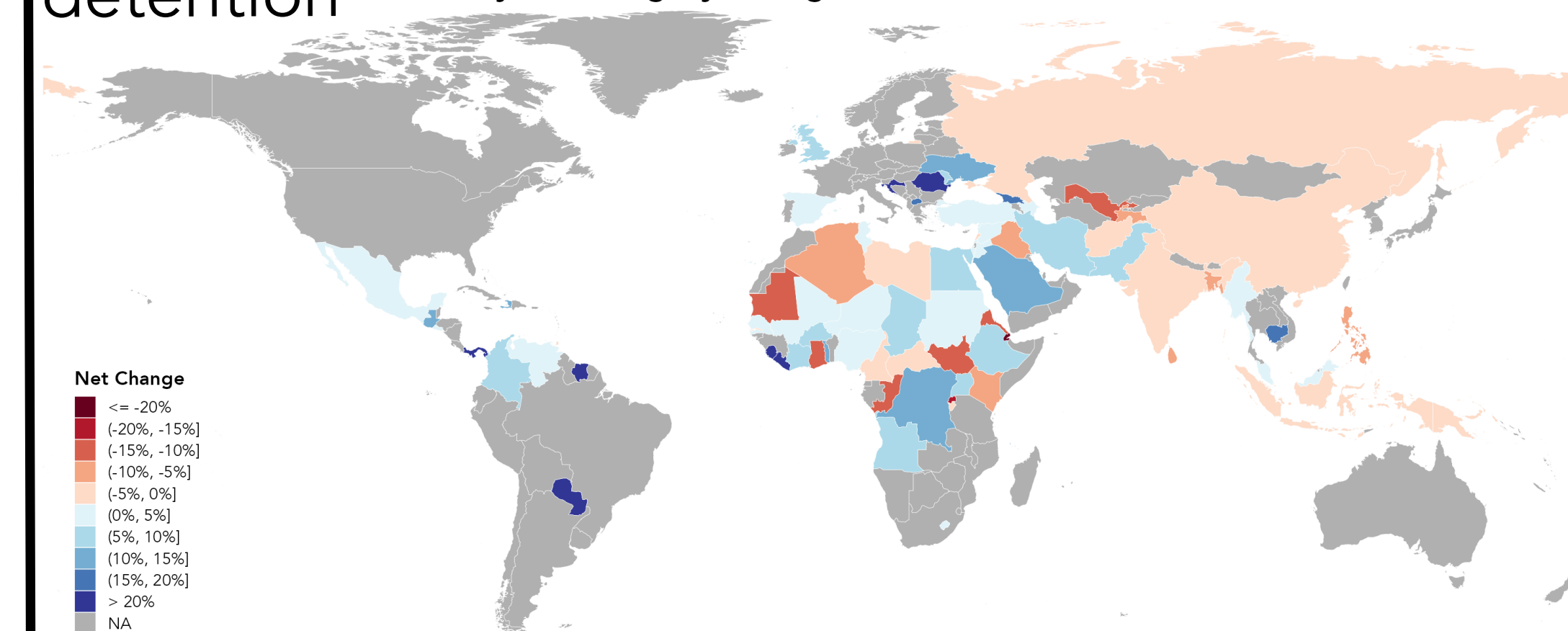
Human Rights Index: freedom from torture, slavery, politically motivated killings, and forced labor

Human Rights Change (5 Years Post-Conflict)

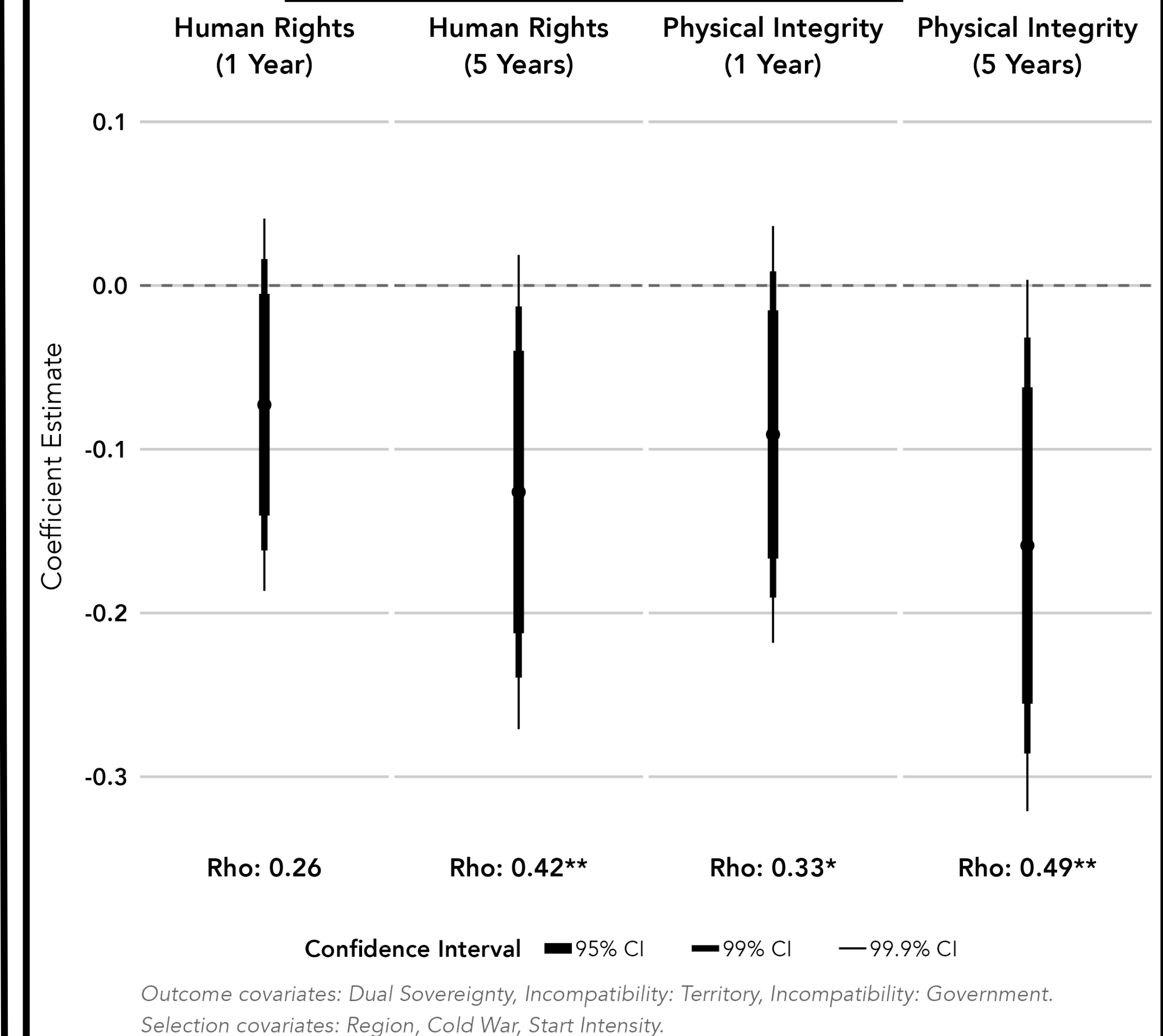


Physical Integrity Rights Index: freedom from slavery, arbitrary detention, & humane treatment in detention

Physical Integrity Change (5 Years Post-Conflict)



Results



Key Findings

- Military intervention results in statistically significantly lower human rights/physical integrity after conflict ends
- Selection bias: cases with intervention are systematically different from non-intervention

Future Directions

- Robustness checks with different types of interventions (by actor and by support type)
- Is conflict recurrence why outcomes are worse 5-years after than 1-year after?